

STORE OPERATIONS

Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) Manual

1. Store Size: 500 sq ft
2. Staff Strength: 8 Members
3. Store Format: Convenience Store
4. Document Version: 2.0
5. Effective Date: 08/05/2026
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SECTION 1: STORE OPENING

Objective: To ensure the store is ready for business and staff are briefed on sales targets and shift assignments.

Total Duration: 45 minutes before opening

Opening Procedures (9 Steps)

Step 1: External Security Check (10 mins)

- Designated employee performs external security check
- Verify all windows and doors are secure
- Check for signs of tampering or forced entry
- Report any suspicious activity immediately to store manager
- 2-Person Verification: Store manager confirms

Step 2: Alarm Deactivation (2 mins)

- Use designated access code to deactivate alarm system
- Record deactivation time in security log
- Verify alarm display shows 'System Disarmed'
- If alarm malfunctions: Contact facility management immediately
- 2-Person Verification: Assistant manager observes code entry

Step 3: POS Boot-Up (5 mins)

- Turn on POS system and all connected terminals
- Wait for system initialization (typically 3-5 minutes)
- Verify all terminals connect to main server successfully
- Check POS logs for any errors or unusual activity
- If errors occur: Contact IT support and document issue
- 2-Person Verification: Supervisor confirms all terminals operational

Step 4: Cash Drawer Float Verification (5 mins)

- Open each cash drawer and verify float amount: ₹5,000 per register
- Use counting denomination: ₹100, ₹50, ₹20, ₹10, ₹5, ₹1 notes
- Record float amount in cash register log with time and initials
- Any variance >₹100 from ₹5,000: Report to store manager
- 2-Person Verification: Cashier and supervisor both sign off

Step 5: Refrigeration Temperature Check (5 mins)

- Check temperature of all refrigerators: Target 0-4°C
- Check temperature of all freezers: Target -18°C or below
- Use calibrated thermometer for accuracy
- Record all temperatures in refrigerator log
- Temperature deviation tolerance: ±1°C acceptable
- If out of range: Inform manager; do not stock products

- 2-Person Verification: Store manager confirms readings

Step 6: Shelf Stocking (20 mins)

- Conduct inventory visual check of all shelves
- Identify out-of-stock and low-stock items
- Restock shelves following FIFO (First In, First Out) method
- Older products moved to front; newer products to back
- Ensure products are organized, neatly aligned, price tags visible
- Report out-of-stock items to store manager
- Check expiry dates while stocking; remove expired products
- 2-Person Verification: One staff member stocks; another verifies

Step 7: Promotional Displays Setup (15 mins)

- Review promotional planogram for the day
- Set up promotional displays in designated high-traffic areas
- Ensure proper signage, pricing, and product arrangement
- Validate all promotional items are in stock
- Take photo of display for records
- Report any issues with display materials to manager
- 2-Person Verification: Visual merchandiser + assistant manager

Step 8: Restroom Prep (10 mins)

- Clean all restroom surfaces: toilets, sinks, mirrors, walls
- Stock toilet paper, paper towels, soap dispensers
- Empty trash cans and replace with fresh liners
- Mop floors and check for wet floor hazards
- Record inspection details in restroom log
- 2-Person Verification: Staff member + visual confirmation

Step 9: Staff Briefing (10 mins)

- Gather all staff members for morning briefing
- Review daily sales targets and zone assignments
- Assign specific shift responsibilities and roles
- Communicate any store updates or promotional activities
- Address staff questions and concerns
- Remind team of customer service standards
- 2-Person Verification: Store manager + assistant manager lead

Store Opening Checklist

Task	Responsible	Duration	Standard	Verified By	✓
External Security Check	Designated Employee	10 min	No tampering	Store Manager	
Alarm	Designated Employee	2 min	System disarmed	Asst Manager	

Deactivation					
POS Boot-Up	IT/Cashier	5 min	All terminals online	Supervisor	
Cash Float Verification	Cashier	5 min	₹5,000 per register	Supervisor	
Fridge/Freezer Temp Check	Cashier	5 min	0-4°C / -18°C	Store Manager	
Shelf Stocking	All Staff	20 min	FIFO, no gaps, tags visible	Staff Pair	
Promotional Displays	Designated Employee	15 min	Per planogram	Visual Merch	
Restroom Prep	Designated Employee	10 min	Clean, stocked, logged	Staff	
Staff Briefing	Store Manager	10 min	Targets, shifts assigned	Manager	

SECTION 2: STORE CLOSING

Objective: To ensure the store is properly closed, secured, and ready for the next day.

Total Duration: 30 minutes after last customer

Closing Procedures (8 Steps)

Step 1: Closing Announcement Protocol (5 mins)

- Make announcement 15 minutes before closing: 'Store closing in 15 minutes'
- Make announcement at closing time: 'Store is now closed'
- Lock all entrance doors immediately after last customer
- Turn off 'Open' sign and external lights
- Move 'Closed' sign to clearly visible location
- 2-Person Verification: Cashier announces; manager confirms

Step 2: Cash Reconciliation (10 mins)

- All cashiers count cash drawer amounts independently
- Compare drawer count with POS system reading
- Acceptable variance: Less than 0.5% of daily sales
- Record all discrepancies in cash reconciliation log
- Two employees verify counts and sign reconciliation report
- Escalate variances >0.5% to store manager for investigation
- 2-Person Verification: Both cashier and supervisor sign off

Step 3: Deep Cleaning Schedule (15 mins)

- Assign specific cleaning areas to each staff member
- Clean all shelves, removing dust and product crumbs
- Clean floor areas thoroughly; use appropriate cleaning agents
- Clean and sanitize checkout counters and POS terminals
- Clean beverage coolers and ice machine exteriors
- Ensure trash bins are emptied throughout store
- Use designated cleaning checklist for all areas
- 2-Person Verification: Visual inspection by supervisor

Step 4: Waste Disposal (10 mins)

- Empty all trash cans into dumpster
- Dispose of cardboard boxes and packaging materials properly
- Identify any damaged products for return/disposal
- Check expiry dates on all visible products
- Record damaged/expired items in disposal log with photos
- Ensure dumpster area is clean and secured
- 2-Person Verification: Staff member documents; manager approves

Step 5: Inventory Count (15 mins)

- Count physical inventory of high-value items
- Use cycle count method for verification
- Record counts in inventory count sheet
- Compare to POS records for discrepancies
- Acceptable variance: Less than 2% per category
- Document any items with variance >2%
- Report findings to store manager for investigation
- 2-Person Verification: Two staff members count; manager verifies

Step 6: Night Deposit Procedure (5 mins)

- Count all cash again and place in night deposit envelope
- Record total cash amount on envelope
- Include all checks and credit card slips
- Seal envelope with tamper-evident tape
- Prepare backup records/receipts
- Store envelope in designated safe until pickup
- Record safe access time and person in security log
- 2-Person Verification: Cashier prepares; manager seals and locks

Step 7: Alarm Activation (3 mins)

- Conduct final walk-through of entire store
- Verify all merchandise areas are secure
- Check that all restroom stalls are empty
- Close all interior doors and windows
- Activate alarm system using designated access code
- Wait for alarm initialization (usually 30 seconds)
- Verify alarm display shows 'System Armed'
- Record activation time and code user in security log
- 2-Person Verification: One staff + manager confirms armed

Step 8: Handover Log Sign-Off (2 mins)

- Store manager reviews all completed tasks
- Manager signs off on handover log with time and date
- Log includes: cash amount, inventory discrepancies, issues found
- Any unresolved items noted for next manager/shift
- Handover log archived for audits and review
- All staff members acknowledge receipt of shift information
- 2-Person Verification: Closing manager + next shift manager

Store Closing Checklist

Task	Responsible	Duration	Standard	Verified By	✓
Closing	Cashiers	5 min	15 min + close	Manager	

Announcements			announcements		
Cash Reconciliation	All Cashiers	10 min	Variance <0.5%	Supervisor	
Deep Cleaning	All Staff	15 min	Per checklist, all areas clean	Manager	
Waste Disposal	Designated Staff	10 min	All waste removed, logged	Manager	
Inventory Count	All Staff	15 min	Variance <2%	Manager	
Night Deposit	Designated Staff	5 min	Sealed, recorded, locked	Manager	
Alarm Activation	Designated Staff	3 min	System armed, logged	Manager	
Handover Log Sign-Off	Store Manager	2 min	All items logged, signed	Manager	

SECTION 3: CASH HANDLING AND POS OPERATIONS

Objective: To maintain accurate, secure, and auditable cash handling and POS operations.

Key Performance Standards

- Daily Cash Variance: <0.5% of daily sales
- Weekly Cash Reconciliation: 100% accurate
- Counterfeit Detection: 100% staff trained
- Register Limits: ₹2,000 maximum per drawer at any time
- Refund Processing Time: <5 minutes with manager approval
- Gift Card Reconciliation: 100% monthly audit

Cash Handling Procedures

Step 1: Counterfeit Detection

- All staff trained on counterfeit currency detection
- Visual inspection: Color, texture, security features
- Check security thread, watermark, and hologram elements
- Use UV counterfeit detection pen when in doubt
- Report any suspected counterfeit notes immediately to manager
- Quarantine suspect notes in designated envelope
- Manager initiates investigation and documents incident
- 2-Person Verification: Staff identifies; manager confirms

Step 2: Drawer Limits

- Maximum cash limit per register: ₹2,000
- When drawer exceeds ₹2,000: Immediately notify store manager
- Manager transfers excess cash to safe using receipt
- Cash transfer recorded in transfer log with time and amount
- Transfer verified by two staff members
- Safe access logged with PIN entry and timestamp
- 2-Person Verification: Cashier + manager for all transfers

Step 3: Z-Reports

- Generate Z-report (End of Day report) at shift end
- Z-report shows total sales, discounts, refunds, taxes collected
- Compare Z-report to drawer count
- Acceptable variance: ≤₹50 or <0.5%
- Document any discrepancies with explanation
- Report significant variances (>0.5%) to store manager
- Archive Z-reports for 90-day audit trail
- 2-Person Verification: Cashier generates; manager reviews

Step 4: Refund Policy

- Refunds ≤₹500: Authorized by any cashier
- Refunds >₹500: Requires store manager approval
- Manager verifies receipt, product condition, return reason
- Record all refunds in POS system with authorization code
- Physical refund processed and receipt issued immediately
- Return reason documented in refund log
- Monthly refund analysis performed to identify trends
- 2-Person Verification: Cashier processes; manager approves/verifies

Step 5: Variance Thresholds

- Daily variance limit: <0.5% of daily sales
- Weekly variance limit: <0.25% of weekly sales
- Monthly variance limit: <0.20% of monthly sales
- Variance investigation: All cases >0.5% require documentation
- Investigation must identify root cause and corrective action
- Pattern analysis: Identify if variance is cashier-specific
- Training intervention: Retraining for high-variance staff
- 2-Person Verification: Manager investigates; supervisor approves

Step 6: Gift Card/Loyalty Program

- All gift card transactions recorded in separate log
- Gift card activation verified in system before sale
- Monthly balance verification: All active cards counted
- Reconcile gift card inventory to system records
- Variance acceptable: <0.1% of total gift card value
- Lost/damaged cards reported and logged
- Loyalty points accuracy checked monthly
- 2-Person Verification: Cashier logs; manager audits

Cash Handling Checklist

Task	Responsible	Frequency	Standard	Verified By	✓
Counterfeit Detection Training	All Staff	Quarterly	100% staff trained	Manager	
Drawer Limit Monitoring	Cashier	Every transaction	Max ₹2,000/drawer	Supervisor	
Z-Report Generation	Cashier	End of shift	Variance <0.5%	Manager	
Refund Processing	Cashier	Per request	<5 min processing	Manager >₹500	
Daily Variance Tracking	Manager	Daily	<0.5% variance	Supervisor	
Gift Card	Manager	Monthly	<0.1%	GM	

Reconciliation			variance		
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SECTION 4: INVENTORY MANAGEMENT

Objective: To ensure proper receiving, rotation, and control of inventory with minimal shrinkage.

Key Inventory Standards

- Inventory Accuracy: $\pm 2\%$ tolerance per category
- Shrinkage Target: $< 1.5\%$ of total inventory value
- Goods Receiving: 100% verification of all deliveries
- Expiry Date Compliance: 0% expired products on shelf
- FIFO Compliance: 100% of products properly rotated
- Cycle Count Frequency: Weekly for high-value items

Inventory Procedures

Step 1: Goods Receiving (GRN Process)

- Verify delivery against purchase order (PO)
- Inspect all goods for damage before acceptance
- Check product quality, packaging integrity, visible defects
- Verify quantity matches PO and delivery challan
- Check for correct product SKU and batch numbers
- Scan all items into GRN (Goods Received Note) system
- Record any discrepancies immediately
- 2-Person Verification: Receiver + store manager verify GRN

Step 2: Quality/Expiry Checks

- Check manufacturing and expiry dates on all products
- Reject products expiring within 30 days
- Inspect packaging for damage, leaks, or contamination
- For refrigerated items: Verify temperature chain maintained
- Document any quality issues in GRN register
- Segregate damaged goods for return/credit
- Communicate return details to vendor
- 2-Person Verification: Receiver + quality checker

Step 3: FIFO Shelf Rotation

- Implement First In, First Out method for all products
- Older products (earlier expiry) placed in front
- Newer products (later expiry) placed at back
- Check expiry dates during daily shelf stocking
- Remove and separate any near-expiry products
- Markdown discounts applied to products $> 80\%$ into shelf life
- Daily rotation verification for perishables
- Weekly verification for non-perishables

- 2-Person Verification: Staff rotation + manager verification

Step 4: Low-Stock Alerts

- Set par levels for each product category
- Monitor stock levels throughout each shift
- Identify items below par level on shelves
- Input low-stock items into reorder system
- Alert store manager when stock falls below 25% par level
- Emergency ordering procedure for critical items
- Forecast stock requirements based on sales trends
- 2-Person Verification: Staff identifies; manager approves order

Step 5: Cycle Counting Schedule

- Conduct weekly cycle counts for high-value items
- Count entire beverage section every week
- Count frozen section every 2 weeks
- Count general merchandise monthly
- Two staff members conduct count independently
- Compare counts; if variance >2%, recount
- Document discrepancies with possible reasons
- 2-Person Verification: Independent counters + manager verification

Step 6: Vendor Returns Process

- Identify damaged or expired items for return
- Obtain return authorization from vendor
- Pack items securely with itemized return list
- Document return with date, items, and reason
- Arrange pickup and obtain return receipt
- Track credit memo processing
- Verify credit applied to next invoice
- 2-Person Verification: Staff prepares; manager approves

Task	Responsible	Frequency	Standard	Verified By	✓
GRN Verification	Receiver	Per delivery	100% items verified	Manager	
Quality/Expiry Check	Quality Checker	Per delivery	0% expired items	Manager	
FIFO Rotation	All Staff	Daily	100% FIFO compliance	Supervisor	
Low-Stock Alerts	All Staff	Per shift	Immediate escalation	Manager	
Cycle Counting	Staff Pair	Weekly (HVI)	Variance <2%	Manager	
Vendor Returns	Designated Staff	As needed	Credit	Manager	

			verified		
Shrinkage Analysis	Manager	Monthly	<1.5% shrinkage	Supervisor	

SECTION 5: CUSTOMER SERVICE STANDARDS

Objective: To maintain consistent, professional customer service that drives loyalty and repeat business.

Customer Service Standards

- Greeting Response Time: Within 10 seconds of entry
- Checkout Time: <3 minutes for average transaction
- Customer Satisfaction: >90% target
- Complaint Resolution: Within 24 hours
- Staff Appearance: Clean, professional, name badge visible
- Store Cleanliness: Visible dirt or clutter zero tolerance

Service Protocols

Greeting Protocol

- Greet every customer within 10 seconds of store entry
- Use friendly, authentic tone: 'Hello! Welcome in!'
- Make eye contact and smile
- If store is busy: 'I'll be with you in just a moment'
- Offer assistance: 'Can I help you find anything?'
- Remember regular customers and their preferences
- 2-Person Verification: Mystery shopper audits monthly

Checkout Experience

- Scan items accurately and at reasonable speed
- Target checkout time: <3 minutes for average transaction
- Make friendly conversation; ask about their day
- Provide receipt and thank customer sincerely
- Offer bag/packaging if applicable
- Suggest complementary products if appropriate
- Loyalty program enrollment for new customers
- 2-Person Verification: Supervisor spot-check during shifts

Handling Complaints

- Listen to complaint without interruption
- Apologize for any inconvenience caused
- Ask clarifying questions to understand issue fully
- Take responsibility; don't make excuses
- Offer immediate solution within your authority
- For issues beyond authority: Escalate to manager immediately
- Follow up within 24 hours to ensure satisfaction
- Document complaint in complaint log for tracking

- 2-Person Verification: Manager handles; documents resolution

Product Knowledge

- All staff trained on product locations and features
- Stock staff can answer basic product questions
- Understand pricing, promotions, and bundled offers
- Know location of alternative products
- Provide recommendations based on customer needs
- Keep product knowledge training updated quarterly
- 2-Person Verification: Manager quizzes staff monthly

SECTION 6: CLEANING AND HYGIENE SCHEDULE

Objective: To maintain a clean, hygienic, and customer-friendly store environment.

Daily Cleaning Schedule

Opening Shift (30 mins)

- Sweep and mop entire sales floor
- Wipe down all checkout counters
- Clean glass doors and windows (exterior and interior)
- Wipe shelves in beverage cooler sections
- Empty and replace trash bins
- Sanitize restroom surfaces and fixtures
- Stock restroom supplies (paper, soap, etc.)
- Check for any spills or hazards

Mid-Shift Deep Clean (15 mins every 4 hours)

- Quick sweep and spot-mop high-traffic areas
- Wipe checkout counters and POS terminals
- Empty overflowing trash bins
- Check restroom cleanliness and resupply
- Address any spills immediately for safety

Closing Shift (30 mins)

- Complete sweep and mop of entire store
- Scrub and sanitize checkout counters thoroughly
- Clean inside refrigeration units (daily wipe-down)
- Clean and sanitize POS terminals
- Wipe all shelves and product displays
- Mop restrooms and disinfect all surfaces
- Empty all trash and replace liners
- Check for any food debris or hazards
- Final walkthrough for cleanliness

Weekly Deep Cleaning (Every Friday)

- Strip and rewax floor in high-traffic areas
- Clean inside windows and skylights
- Deep clean refrigeration units (inside and coils)
- Clean storage areas and back room
- Wash entrance floor mat
- Sanitize all customer-facing surfaces
- Organize stock room and discard packing materials

Monthly Deep Cleaning (First Friday)

- Professional carpet/floor cleaning if applicable
- Deep clean all refrigeration units
- Clean all light fixtures and replace bulbs
- Wash ceiling areas and remove any cobwebs
- Sanitize all shelves and storage areas
- Professional cleaning of entrance exterior
- Full inspection by store manager

Hygiene Standards

- Staff Hygiene: Hand washing before each task
- Uniform: Clean, professional appearance daily
- Food Safety: Follow all food handling guidelines
- Allergen Awareness: Staff trained on allergen protocols
- Spill Management: Immediate cleanup and hazard warning
- Pest Control: Regular monitoring; immediate action on sightings
- Waste Segregation: Proper disposal of different waste types

SECTION 7: SECURITY AND LOSS PREVENTION

Objective: To protect store assets, prevent theft, and ensure staff and customer safety.

Loss Prevention Targets

- Shrinkage Rate: <1.5% of inventory value
- Incident-Free Days: >95% of operating days
- Security System Uptime: 99.9%
- Alarm False Alarms: <2 per month
- Staff Incident Reports: 100% documentation

Security Procedures

External Security

- Daily security check before opening (see Section 1)
- Check all windows, doors, and entry points
- Look for signs of tampering or forced entry
- Verify exterior lighting is operational
- Report any suspicious activity immediately
- Document all incidents with details and photos
- 2-Person Verification: Security + store manager

Internal Security

- Maintain store cleanliness to eliminate hiding spots
- Install security cameras in all public areas
- Ensure cameras cover all high-value product areas
- Monitor camera feeds during closing procedures
- Retain video footage for 60 days minimum
- Access to cameras restricted to management
- 2-Person Verification: Manager reviews footage weekly

Cash Security

- Keep cash drawer locked when cashier absent
- Only manager can access safe without supervision
- Safe access logged with time and person
- Safe combination changed quarterly
- Night deposit envelope locked in safe
- No cash left in drawers overnight
- 2-Person Verification: All cash handling supervised

Merchandise Security

- High-value items stored in locked display cases
- Cigarettes/liquor secured with limited access

- Regular inventory checks for shrinkage
- Immediate investigation of any shrinkage
- Suspicious activity reported to manager
- Customer bag checks at exit if needed
- 2-Person Verification: Manager authorizes security measures

SECTION 8: VISUAL MERCHANDISING

Objective: To create attractive, organized displays that maximize sales and enhance customer experience.

Merchandising Standards

- Planogram Compliance: 100% of displays match approved planograms
- Display Freshness: Weekly updates for promotional displays
- Shelf Appearance: No gaps, no price tag violations, organized
- Signage: All prices visible, promotional signs accurate
- Traffic Flow: Products logically arranged for easy navigation
- Cross-Merchandising: Complementary items placed together

Display Setup Procedures

Planogram Compliance

- Obtain approved planogram from marketing/management
- Set up display exactly as per planogram specifications
- Place products in correct sequence and orientation
- Ensure price tags match product placement
- All SKUs visible and clearly identified
- Stock depth and height per planogram instructions
- Take photo after setup for documentation
- 2-Person Verification: Visual merchandiser + manager confirm

Daily Shelf Maintenance

- Check all shelves for gaps or empty spaces
- Fill gaps immediately; maintain full shelf appearance
- Straighten all products; align edges and faces
- Ensure all price tags are correctly positioned
- Check all price tags for accuracy and readability
- Spot clean any dirt or debris on products
- Rotate products daily for freshness (FIFO method)
- Document any merchandising issues
- 2-Person Verification: Shelf staff + supervisor inspection

Promotional Display Setup

- Confirm promotional products with marketing team
- Set up displays in high-traffic areas
- Use eye-catching signage and banners
- Create clear promotional messaging
- Ensure adequate product stocking for promotion
- Position best-sellers at eye level

- Cross-merchandise with complementary items
- Update displays weekly or per promotion schedule
- 2-Person Verification: Visual merchandiser + store manager

Seasonal/Special Displays

- Plan displays 2 weeks before seasonal events
- Create themed displays for holidays/events
- Use decorations to enhance store atmosphere
- Ensure displays reflect current trends
- Highlight seasonal products prominently
- Train staff on seasonal selling points
- Update displays every 2 weeks minimum
- 2-Person Verification: Marketing + store manager approval

SECTION 9: STAFF MANAGEMENT

Objective: To recruit, train, and develop a high-performing team committed to service excellence.

Staff Management Standards

- Staff Turnover: <25% annually
- Training Completion: 100% of staff trained within 30 days
- Attendance Rate: >95% on-time arrival
- Performance Reviews: Quarterly for all staff
- Incident-Free Record: 0 tolerance for misconduct
- Staff Engagement Score: >80% satisfaction

Recruitment and Onboarding

New Hire Procedures

- Conduct structured interview assessment
- Verify references and background check
- Explain job duties, expectations, and benefits
- Provide store tour and facility orientation
- Assign mentor/buddy for first week
- Complete required documentation (tax, banking, etc.)
- Obtain signed acknowledgment of SOP manual
- Schedule orientation with store manager
- 2-Person Verification: HR + store manager

Training Program (30 days)

- Day 1: Store orientation and introduction
- Days 2-3: POS system training with hands-on practice
- Days 4-5: Cash handling and security procedures
- Days 6-7: Customer service standards and protocols
- Days 8-9: Inventory management and shelf stocking
- Days 10-14: Supervised shifts (paired with mentor)
- Days 15-21: Independent shifts (with manager check-ins)
- Days 22-30: Full responsibilities with periodic reviews
- End of month: Competency assessment
- 2-Person Verification: Trainer + manager assess competency

Ongoing Training

- Monthly product knowledge updates
- Quarterly safety and security training refresh
- Semi-annual customer service excellence training
- Annual compliance and policy review
- Targeted training for identified skill gaps

- Cross-training for operational flexibility
- Leadership development for advancement track
- 2-Person Verification: Manager confirms completion

Performance Management

Attendance Policy

- Expected arrival time: 10 minutes before shift start
- Tardiness: 3 instances = warning; 5+ = disciplinary action
- Absences: Notify manager 2 hours before shift (if possible)
- Unexcused absence: Immediate manager discussion
- Attendance tracked monthly and reviewed quarterly
- Perfect attendance recognized and rewarded

Performance Reviews

- Quarterly reviews for all staff members
- Formal annual review documenting achievements/gaps
- Review covers: attendance, performance, customer feedback
- Identify training needs and development opportunities
- Set goals for next quarter/year
- Discuss compensation and advancement opportunities
- 2-Person Verification: Manager + HR conduct review

Disciplinary Actions

- Minor infractions: Verbal warning + documentation
- Repeated infractions: Written warning with action plan
- Serious violations: Suspension or termination
- All disciplinary actions documented and filed
- Staff member receives copy of disciplinary notice
- Appeals process available within 7 days
- Progressive discipline applied consistently

SECTION 10: EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

Objective: To ensure all staff are prepared to respond effectively to emergencies and protect life and property.

Emergency Response Standards

- Response Time: <2 minutes to any emergency activation
- Staff Training: 100% trained in basic emergency procedures
- Evacuation Drills: Quarterly minimum
- Emergency Equipment: Monthly inspection/testing
- Communication: Clear chain of command established

Fire Emergency

Upon Fire Detection

- IMMEDIATELY activate fire alarm (pull handle if needed)
- Evacuate store using nearest exit
- Assist any customers or staff in vicinity
- DO NOT attempt to extinguish large fires
- DO NOT return to store for any reason
- Meet at designated assembly point (parking lot)
- Wait for fire department and emergency personnel
- Account for all staff members and notify manager
- 2-Person Verification: Designate one staff to account for people

Using Fire Extinguisher (Small Fire Only)

- ONLY if fire is small and contained
- ONLY if you have been trained
- Remember PASS: Pull-Aim-Squeeze-Sweep
- Pull pin from fire extinguisher
- Aim nozzle at base of fire
- Squeeze handle firmly
- Sweep side to side until fire is out
- Still evacuate after extinguishing
- Allow no one to re-enter until fire department confirms safety

Fire Emergency Post-Actions

- Cooperate fully with fire department personnel
- Provide information about fire origin/extent
- Do not touch or disturb any evidence
- Account for inventory and valuables if safe to do so
- Contact store manager and corporate office immediately
- File incident report within 24 hours

- Arrange for building inspection before reopening
- 2-Person Verification: Manager files report with corporate

Power Outage

Upon Power Loss

- IMMEDIATELY stop all transactions and secure cash drawer
- Close POS terminals gracefully (if possible) to avoid data loss
- Place 'Closed' sign at all entrances
- Keep customers already in store calm and collected
- DO NOT allow new customers to enter
- Explain situation: 'We're experiencing a temporary power outage'
- Estimate 10-15 minutes for restoration
- Contact facility management and report outage
- 2-Person Verification: Manager assesses and communicates

During Prolonged Outage (>30 mins)

- Evacuate all customers from store
- Direct to exit using emergency lighting/flashlights
- Provide phone number for updates if possible
- Monitor refrigeration units; note items affected
- Close all refrigeration/freezer doors to preserve temperature
- Post notice: 'Due to power outage, store is temporarily closed'
- Document start time and duration of outage
- 2-Person Verification: Manager oversees evacuation

Power Restoration

- Turn off all main switches to prevent surge damage
- Wait 5 minutes after power returns
- Turn switches back on gradually (1 minute intervals)
- Check POS system startup; resolve any data issues
- Verify refrigeration unit temperatures are safe
- Check security system and alarm system
- Remove 'Closed' signs and reopen store
- Document affected inventory and potential losses
- File incident report with corporate office
- 2-Person Verification: Manager verifies all systems operational

Medical Emergency

Upon Medical Emergency Discovery

- Remain calm and assess situation quickly
- Call emergency services (911) immediately

- Provide dispatcher with clear location and symptoms
- Keep person comfortable (move to quiet area if safe)
- DO NOT move person unless in immediate danger
- Keep person conscious and talking if possible
- Notify store manager immediately
- Gather any relevant information (allergies, medications)
- Clear area around person; ensure privacy
- 2-Person Verification: One staff calls 911; other assists person

Awaiting Emergency Personnel

- Keep person calm and reassured
- Monitor vital signs if trained (breathing, consciousness)
- Use AED (Automated External Defibrillator) if available and trained
- Preserve scene for emergency responders
- Keep all customers and unnecessary staff away
- Have someone wait at entrance to guide paramedics
- Gather medical information if available
- Do not give medical advice or medications

Post-Emergency Actions

- Cooperate with paramedics and provide information
- Record incident details immediately after
- Get contact information from any witnesses
- Contact store manager and corporate office
- Complete incident report within 24 hours
- Arrange counseling for traumatized staff if needed
- Clean and sanitize area as needed
- Follow up with customer if appropriate and safe
- 2-Person Verification: Manager files comprehensive report

Security Incident/Robbery

During Robbery/Security Threat

- PRIORITIZE PERSONAL SAFETY - DO NOT RESIST
- Comply with any demands for cash/products
- Trigger silent alarm if possible without endangering self
- Remain calm and observe robber appearance/distinguishing marks
- Note vehicle description if applicable
- DO NOT attempt to chase or apprehend robber
- Account for all staff members; ensure no one is harmed
- 2-Person Verification: Multiple staff observe incident

Immediately After Robbery

- Call emergency services (911) from safe location
- Provide dispatcher with robber description and direction of travel
- Lock all doors and secure the store
- DO NOT touch or disturb crime scene
- Gather all staff in designated safe area
- Account for all staff members and customers
- Document what was taken (amount, products, serial numbers)
- Preserve video footage (do not overwrite recordings)
- Notify store manager and corporate office immediately
- 2-Person Verification: Manager calls 911; another secures store

Police Investigation

- Cooperate fully with police investigation
- Provide all available information and video
- DO NOT reveal information to media without authorization
- Arrange counseling for traumatized staff
- File comprehensive incident report with corporate
- Review security procedures and identify improvements
- Consider enhanced security measures (cameras, alarms, lighting)
- 2-Person Verification: Manager handles police liaison and reporting

SECTION 11: DAILY/WEEKLY/MONTHLY AUDIT CHECKLISTS

Daily Audit Checklist

Category	Item	Standard	Status	Notes	Verified By
Opening	Alarm deactivated on time	Before 06:00 AM	✓		
Opening	Cash float verified	₹5,000 per register	✓		
POS	System operational	All terminals online	✓		
Temp	Fridge/Freezer temp	0-4°C / -18°C	✓		
Stock	Shelf stocking completed	All items stocked	✓		
Cleanliness	Store appearance	Clean and organized	✓		
Closing	Cash reconciliation	Variance <0.5%	✓		
Closing	Inventory count	Variance <2%	✓		
Security	Alarm activated	System armed	✓		
Overall	Handover log signed	Complete and signed	✓		

Weekly Audit Checklist

Category	Task	Frequency	Standard	Completed	Verified By
Inventory	Cycle count high-value items	Weekly	<2% variance	✓	
Cleaning	Deep clean refrigerators	Weekly	Visible cleanliness	✓	
Cleaning	Floor stripping and waxing	Weekly	Professional appearance	✓	
Compliance	Price accuracy audit	Weekly	100% correct prices	✓	
Expiry	Check all product expiries	Weekly	0% expired products	✓	
Training	Staff competency review	Weekly	100% competent	✓	
Reports	Variance investigation	Weekly	All variances <0.5%	✓	

Monthly Audit Checklist

Category	Task	Standard	Status	Findings	Verified By
Financial	Cash variance review	<0.25% of sales	✓		
Inventory	Complete physical count	<2% variance	✓		
Shrinkage	Shrinkage analysis	<1.5% of value	✓		
Compliance	Regulatory compliance check	100% compliant	✓		
Staff	Performance review	All staff rated	✓		
Security	Camera footage review	60-day retention	✓		
Cleaning	Professional deep clean	All areas cleaned	✓		
Reports	Incident report summary	All documented	✓		

ANNEXURES

Fillable Forms and Reference Documents

ANNEXURE 1: STAFF BREAK SCHEDULE

Month/Year: _____

Store Manager: _____

GUIDELINES:

- Lunch Break: 30 minutes (1 staff max per break)
- Tea Break: 15 minutes (staggered)
- No more than 1 staff absent at any time
- Breaks not carried over to next day

Week	Mon Lunch	Mon Tea	Tue Lunch	Tue Tea	Wed Lunch	Wed Tea
Week 1	___	___	___	___	___	___
Week 2	___	___	___	___	___	___
Week 3	___	___	___	___	___	___
Week 4	___	___	___	___	___	___

Approval:

Store Manager: _____ Date: _____

HR Supervisor: _____ Date: _____

ANNEXURE 2: TRAINING MATRIX

Store Location: _____

Review Period: _____

COMPETENCY LEVELS: N = Not Trained | I = In Progress | C = Competent | E = Expert

Staff Name	POS System	Cash Handling	Customer Service	Inventory	Safety	Status
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Training Needs/Gap Areas:

Approved By: _____ Date: _____

ANNEXURE 3: INCIDENT REPORTING FORM

INCIDENT DETAILS

Date of Incident: _____ Time: _____ AM/PM

Location in Store: _____

Reported By: _____ Date Reported: _____

TYPE OF INCIDENT (Check One):

- ☐ Injury/Medical ☐ Theft/Loss ☐ Accident ☐ Security ☐ Other

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

PEOPLE INVOLVED:

Name: _____ Role: _____ Injured: Yes/No

Name: _____ Role: _____ Injured: Yes/No

WITNESSES:

Name: _____ Contact: _____

Name: _____ Contact: _____

IMMEDIATE ACTIONS TAKEN:

ESTIMATED LOSS/DAMAGE: ₹ _____

MANAGER REVIEW:

Manager Name: _____ Signature: _____

Review Date: _____ Follow-Up Action: _____

ANNEXURE 4: RETURN/EXCHANGE FORM

CUSTOMER INFORMATION:

Customer Name: _____

Contact Number: _____ Date: _____

PRODUCT DETAILS:

Product Name: _____

Product SKU: _____ Price Paid: ₹ _____

Original Purchase Date: _____ Receipt #: _____

Product Condition: ☐ New ☐ Opened ☐ Used ☐ Damaged

REASON FOR RETURN/EXCHANGE:

- ☐ Defective Product ☐ Wrong Item ☐ Damaged ☐ Changed Mind

Details: _____

RETURN ACTION:

☐ Refund ☐ Exchange ☐ Store Credit

If Exchange - New Product: _____

APPROVAL:

Refund Amount: ₹ _____ (if applicable)

Approved By: _____ Signature: _____

Date: _____ Time: _____

PAYMENT METHOD (If Refund):

- ☐ Original Card ☐ Cash ☐ Store Credit

ANNEXURE 5: COMPETITOR PRICE CHECK FORM

SUBMISSION DETAILS:

Check Date: _____ Checked By: _____

Competitor Store: _____ Location: _____

Visit Time: _____ AM/PM

PRICE COMPARISON DATA:

Product SKU	Product Name	Our Price (₹)	Competitor Price (₹)	Difference (₹)	Status
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	

OBSERVATIONS:

RECOMMENDATIONS:

Review By: _____ Date: _____

ANNEXURE 6: PROMOTIONAL EFFECTIVENESS REPORT FORM

PROMOTION DETAILS:

Promotion Name: _____

Duration: From _____ To _____

- Promotion Type: ☐ Discount ☐ Bundle ☐ Gift With Purchase ☐ Other

SALES METRICS:

Promoted Product Sales (Units): _____

Promoted Product Sales (Value): ₹ _____

Baseline Period Sales (Units): _____

Baseline Period Sales (Value): ₹ _____

Sales Increase %: _____

TRAFFIC & CONVERSION:

Store Traffic During Promotion: _____ visits

Baseline Period Traffic: _____ visits

Traffic Increase %: _____

Conversion Rate: _____ %

PROFITABILITY ANALYSIS:

Promotion Cost (Discount): ₹ _____

Net Additional Revenue: ₹ _____

ROI %: _____

CUSTOMER FEEDBACK:

Customer Satisfaction: ☐ Excellent ☐ Good ☐ Average ☐ Poor

Comments: _____

OVERALL ASSESSMENT:

- ☐ Highly Successful - Repeat ☐ Successful - Monitor ☐ Needs Improvement ☐ Unsuccessful

Analyzed By: _____ Date: _____

Approved By: _____ Date: _____

ANNEXURE 7: EMERGENCY PROCEDURES QUICK REFERENCE

EMERGENCY CONTACT NUMBERS:

Emergency Service	Contact Number	Notes
Police/Fire/Ambulance	911	For all life-threatening emergencies
Poison Control	1-800-222-1222	Medical poisoning/overdose
Store Manager	_____	_____ (Mobile)
Store Supervisor	_____	_____ (Mobile)
Corporate Office	_____	24-hour support line
Facility Management	_____	Building/utilities issues
Security Company	_____	Alarm/surveillance support

LOCATION INFORMATION (For Emergency Personnel):

Store Address: _____

Store Phone: _____

Manager Name: _____ Mobile: _____

Nearest Cross Street: _____

Accessible Entrance: _____

ASSEMBLY POINT (In case of evacuation):

Location: _____

Distance from Store: _____

EMERGENCY EQUIPMENT LOCATION:

Fire Extinguishers: _____ Location: _____

First Aid Kit: _____ Location: _____

AED (Defibrillator): _____ Location: _____

Emergency Exit: _____ Location: _____

Emergency Exit: _____ Location: _____

QUICK RESPONSE CHECKLIST:

Situation	First Action	Second Action	Contact
Fire	Activate alarm	Evacuate immediately	911
Medical Emergency	Call 911	Apply first aid if trained	Manager
Robbery/Threat	Comply with demands	Trigger silent alarm	911
Power Outage	Close doors	Evacuate if >30 mins	Facility Mgmt
Accident/Injury	Secure area	Call 911 if serious	Manager
Suspicious Person	Avoid confrontation	Notify manager	Police if threat

STAFF ACKNOWLEDGMENT:

I acknowledge that I have received and read the Emergency Procedures Reference document.

I understand my role in emergency situations and commit to following all procedures.

Staff Name (Print): _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____